★ MURDER AT THE DEADWOOD CANTINA ★

Poker Alice

The cantina's poker dealer — loyal to her favorite barmaid, Billie.

How to Play It

A real woman of the West. Watch everyone like you're dealing cards, keep your feelings close to the vest, and fish for information.

Starter Lines

1. Henrietta, what a lovely necklace! Now how'd you afford that, with the cantina in such a pickle?
2. Jesse Wales, what happened to that hand of yours? And just why are you in town?
3. Anna Belle, you're barkin' up the wrong tree — you've got the wrong card player, honey. 3

Be Ready If Asked

"Why did you let so much cheating go on in the tournament?" → "I deal the cards, I don't read minds. Bring me proof."

"Someone saw you coming out of the bank during the robbery!" → "Whoever said that has an axe to grind. Consider the source."

"What's the deal with you and Billie?" → "Billie's my dearest friend in Deadwood, and that's all you need to know."

When to use these: After Harry's welcome, go find the person each line mentions (or anyone nearby) and work all three into conversation before the lights go out. Tell the host quietly when you're done. After the murder, follow your B envelope.

OBJECTIVES

Poker Alice

Starting Objectives:

- Find out from Harry High-Stakes (the cantina owner) if you need to worry about the cantina closing.
- Ask Billie-The-Bartender (the cantina barmaid and bookkeeper) about the cantina finances.
- Confess your true feelings of loyalty to Billie-The-Bartender and ask her to stand by you no matter what.
- Compliment Henrietta High-Stakes (Harry's business partner) on her lovely necklace. Question where she got the money to purchase it from.
- Ask Jesse Wales (an outlaw) why they are in town. Find out what happened to Jesse's wounded hand.
- Tell Gambling Jack (a card player) that he needs to be more discreet if he intends to keep his secret (that he cheats at poker). Make Jack pay you so you do not spread the rumor.
- If you hear Anna Belle (Gambling Jack's backer) accuse

  card player, but do not tell her who the real culprit is.



©Night of Mystery, www.nightofmystery.com

Night of Mystery

Poker Alice

Born Alice Ivers in England in 1851, you were educated in England and moved with your family to the new land and settled in the West. Shortly after settling, you found yourself bored with the farming lifestyle and ran off with Black Bart, a bandit! Over a years time, you and Bart gallivanted over the West reaping havoc with many unlawful and deadly acts, earning you the name of "Assassin Alice". Unfortunately, Bart was soon caught and hung for his dastardly deeds. Not wanting to end up like your dead partner-in-crime, you found yourself alone and seeking a new, exciting-but-lawful life in the West.

Once single, you began hanging out in card halls, where you became a professional poker dealer. As a popular poker dealer, you moved around and worked at various card houses and often travelled to wherever was paying the most money for their dealers. However, about six months ago when you were passing through Deadwood, Harry High-Stakes (the Deadwood Cantina owner) offered you a steady job tending bar and dealing cards at his cantina. Harry's offer was too good to refuse and you decided to settle here in Deadwood.

Even though your life in Deadwood is simple, you keep it exciting. Billie-The-Bartender (the Deadwood Cantina barmaid and bookkeeper) admires you and, while you enjoy the attention that she pays you, you have hesitated at furthering the relationship. Since Billie is concerned about staying on the "right side" of the law, you fear she may be unaccepting of your outlaw past. Although you have yet to return Billie's feelings of loyalty, you know that you can exploit Billie's adoration to get whatever you want from her, including information on the cantina. Among other tidbits, Billie has told you that the cantina is in financial trouble and that Harry does not trust Henrietta (Harry's business partner) with the finances of the cantina.

With the tournament in town this week, you have seen Jesse Wales (an outlaw) back in Deadwood. There are rumors that Jesse is back in town to collect a debt from Harry, but you also suspect that Jesse's motives might be to expose you. (There is a reward out for your apprehension.) Coincidentally, during Jesse's visit to town, you have noticed that Jesse has been spending some time with Barb Cassidy (another outlaw). You wonder if Jesse's relationship with Barb is strictly business or pleasure.

With the poker tournament over, you are looking forward to the Deadwood Poker Tournament Party. While dealing cards in the tournament, you had the opportunity to observe an array of distinct characters that were visiting Deadwood. At the party, it will be interesting to see how everyone interacts in a room together for the evening. In addition, you are anxious to see Gambling Jack (a card player in the tournament). Although Jack did not win the tournament, you are certain that you witnessed Jack counting cards and you wonder what his reaction will be when you confront him about his cheating. In addition, you are fairly certain that Clay Coldwell (a card player) may have also been cheating, but you have no proof in the matter.



Acting and Dressing Your Part: As a real woman of the West and a resident of Deadwood, you dress with a flare for the West. Within your outfit, you may want to include boots, a hat, a bandana, shoestring tie, spurs, fringe, chaps and any other accessory you desire. *For more ideas on how to dress and a glossary of wild western words and phrases to use at the party, please see please see the party tips section at www.nightofmystery.com. Simply type in murderatthedeadwoodcantina.com and explore the guest info and costuming sections on the website.*

© Night of Mystery Inc. - www.nightofmystery.com